

TAYLOR DASCH

EG REALTY • TEMPLE, TX

THE FORT CAVAZOS CORRIDOR BUYER'S GUIDE

Where to Live Near Fort Cavazos

5 Central Texas cities, compared on real numbers

*Killeen • Copperas Cove • Temple • Harker Heights • Belton — so you choose
by fit, not by a sign in a yard.*

The same ~1,800 sq ft house runs about \$252,000 in Killeen but about \$302,000 in Belton — nearly \$50,000 for the identical home. The towns are 15–40 minutes apart. The price tags, commutes, and school districts are not.

A market-data breakdown by Taylor Dasch — a Central Texas agent who reads the Bell County MLS every week.

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UPDATED JUNE 2026 • REAL MLS & DRIVE-TIME DATA

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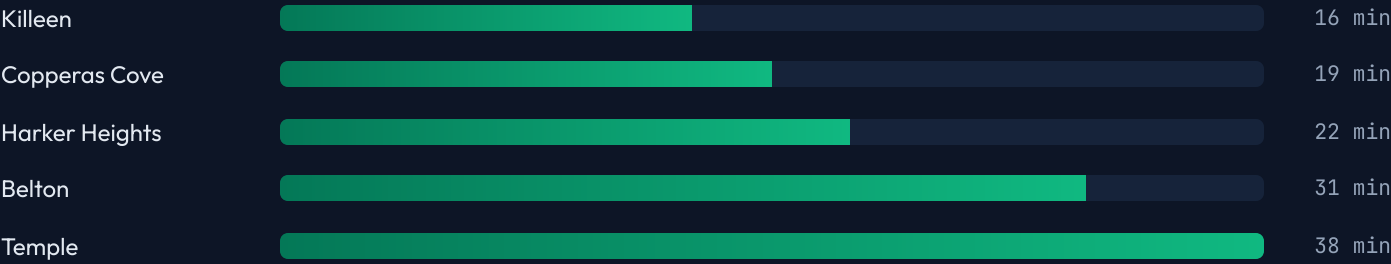
The five-city corridor, at a glance

If you're PCS-ing to Fort Cavazos or relocating anywhere in the Central Texas corridor, you have five real choices — and they are not interchangeable. A median home is a \$240,000 buy in Killeen and a \$335,000 buy in Belton, the gate commute swings from 16 to 38 minutes, and the school district changes with the city line. Here are the real June 2026 MLS numbers for all five. Skim the table, find your priority in the decision matrix at the end, then read that city's page.

CITY	MEDIAN PRICE	MEDIAN SIZE	~ \$/SQ FT	DAYS ON MKT	TO GATE	TO BSW TEMPLE	SCHOOL DISTRICT
Killeen	\$240,000	1,716 sq ft	~\$140	54	~16 min	~34 min	Killeen ISD
Copperas Cove	\$245,000	1,654 sq ft	~\$148	52	~19 min	~39 min	Copperas Cove ISD
Temple	\$279,900	1,808 sq ft	~\$155	64	~38 min	~9 min	Temple ISD*
Harker Heights	\$312,500	2,149 sq ft	~\$145	58	~22 min	~25 min	Killeen ISD
Belton	\$334,895	1,994 sq ft	~\$168	68	~31 min	~16 min	Belton ISD

*Temple is split: West Temple communities run Belton ISD and some northeast areas run Academy ISD — see the Temple page. Confirm any district by exact address.

MINUTES TO THE FORT CAVAZOS GATE



Off-peak driving estimates from each city center to the Fort Cavazos main gate (Google Maps). Morning gate rush adds time. If the base is your daily run, this chart is your shortlist; if you work at Baylor Scott & White in Temple, flip it — Temple is ~9 minutes and Cove is ~39.

The honest read on each

Every city below gets the same treatment: the real median numbers, who it fits, and the honest catch. There is no single "best" — only the best fit for your budget, your commute, and your kids' schools.

01 Killeen

Cheapest entry price in the corridor and the shortest drive to the gate.

\$240K MEDIAN PRICE	1,716 MEDIAN SQ FT	~\$140 PER SQ FT	54 DAYS ON MARKET
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SCHOOLS
Killeen ISD

COMMUTE
~16 min to Fort Cavazos · ~34 min to BSW Temple

NEIGHBORHOODS
Goodnight Ranch, Turnbo Ranch, Victory Ranch, Levy Crossing, Mitchell Farms

NEW CONSTRUCTION
D.R. Horton, Stylecraft, Carothers Homes, Flintrock

WHAT YOUR MONEY BUYS

Around \$229K (just under the median): a 3-bed / 2-bath, ~1,566 sq ft updated four-sided brick home in Oak Valley, near schools and highways.

BEST FOR
Soldiers and families stationed at Fort Cavazos who want the shortest gate commute and the most square footage per dollar in the corridor.

THE HONEST CATCH
The most affordable corridor city and closest to base, but it carries higher housing turnover and a longer drive (~34 min) to Temple's medical district than the east-side towns.

02 Copperas Cove

Killeen-level budget math, on the west side of the corridor — and the fastest-selling market.

\$245K

MEDIAN PRICE

1,654

MEDIAN SQ FT

~\$148

PER SQ FT

52

DAYS ON MARKET

SCHOOLS

Copperas Cove ISD

COMMUTE

~19 min to Fort Cavazos · ~39 min to BSW Temple

NEIGHBORHOODS

Creekside Hills, Freedom Ranch, Clayton Ranch, House Creek North, Western Hills Estates

NEW CONSTRUCTION

D.R. Horton, Flintrock, Stylecraft, JClark Homes

WHAT YOUR MONEY BUYS

Around \$257K (right at the median): a 2024-build 3-bed / 2-bath, ~1,436 sq ft single-story with an open-concept layout in Creekside Hills.

BEST FOR

Budget-focused buyers and base commuters who want the most square footage per dollar and the fastest-moving market in the corridor.

THE HONEST CATCH

It's the longest drive to Temple / BSW of the five (~39 min), so it fits base commuters far better than anyone working in Temple.

03 Temple

The central, healthcare-anchored hub — closest to BSW, farthest from the gate.

\$280K

MEDIAN PRICE

1,808

MEDIAN SQ FT

~\$155

PER SQ FT

64

DAYS ON MARKET

SCHOOLS

Temple ISD (mixed — see note)

COMMUTE

~38 min to Fort Cavazos · ~9 min to BSW Temple

NEIGHBORHOODS

Oak Ridge, Mesa Ridge, Pecan Creek, The Parks at Westfield, Lake Pointe

NEW CONSTRUCTION

D.R. Horton, Carothers Executive Homes, Stylecraft, Omega, Flintrock

WHAT YOUR MONEY BUYS

Around \$275K (just under the median): a 4-bed / 2-bath, ~2,045 sq ft single-story brick home in southeast Temple (Echo Village).

BEST FOR

Buyers who work at or near Baylor Scott & White, want the most central I-35, shopping, and airport access, and don't need a daily gate run.

THE HONEST CATCH

Mid-pack on price and the farthest regular drive to the Fort Cavazos gate (~38 min) — a better fit for hospital and I-35 commuters than for daily base traffic.

Buyers miss this: "Temple" doesn't mean Temple ISD everywhere. West Temple communities like Lake Pointe and parts of Westfield are zoned **Belton ISD**, and some northeast/Academy-area addresses fall in **Academy ISD**. Confirm the assigned campus by exact address before you fall for a house over its schools.

04 Harker Heights

The most square footage in the corridor and the Killeen-ISD draw, a short hop from the gate.

\$313K

MEDIAN PRICE

2,149

MEDIAN SQ FT

~\$145

PER SQ FT

58

DAYS ON MARKET

SCHOOLS

Killeen ISD

COMMUTE

~22 min to Fort Cavazos · ~25 min to BSW Temple

NEIGHBORHOODS

Skipcha Mountain Estates, Highland Oaks Estates, Evergreen, The Vineyard, Knights Ridge

NEW CONSTRUCTION

D.R. Horton, Centex, King Signature Homes, Carothers

WHAT YOUR MONEY BUYS

Around \$310K (just under the median): a 4-bed / 2.5-bath, ~2,119 sq ft home in The Vineyard — right at the city's median size.

BEST FOR

Families who want the biggest homes in the corridor and a strong Killeen ISD draw while staying ~20 minutes from the gate, and will pay a step up over Killeen for it.

THE HONEST CATCH

At ~\$145/sq ft you get the largest median home of the five, but a higher total price than Killeen or Cove — and it shares Killeen ISD, so confirm the specific assigned campus, not just the district.

05 Belton

Newest construction, Belton ISD, and lake access — at the top of the price range.

\$335K

MEDIAN PRICE

1,994

MEDIAN SQ FT

~\$168

PER SQ FT

68

DAYS ON MARKET

SCHOOLS

Belton ISD

COMMUTE

~31 min to Fort Cavazos · ~16 min to BSW Temple

NEIGHBORHOODS

Three Creeks, Hubbard Branch, Skyview, Dawson Ridge, Ridge at Belle Meadows

NEW CONSTRUCTION

D.R. Horton, Stylecraft, Centex, Ashford Homes

WHAT YOUR MONEY BUYS

Around \$335K (at the median): a 4-bed / 3-bath, ~2,092 sq ft single-story in Three Creeks with a guest suite off the entry.

BEST FOR

Commuters who want the newest construction, Belton ISD schools, and Belton Lake / Stillhouse Hollow access, and have the budget for the corridor's top median price.

THE HONEST CATCH

Highest price per square foot and the slowest market of the five (68 days) — you trade some drive time to the gate (~31 min) and pay a premium for newer inventory and the Belton ISD and lake draw.

PLAIN-ENGLISH VERDICT

So which one is yours?

Here's how I'd actually narrow it down with a client. Start from your hard constraint — the gate run, the budget, or the schools — and the city follows.

Lowest entry price and the shortest gate run

Killeen

Cheapest median in the corridor (~\$240K) and the closest regular drive to the Fort Cavazos gate (~16 min).

Affordable square footage with a fast base commute

Copperas Cove

Killeen-level budget math and a quick (~19 min) gate run; just plan on a longer haul to Temple.

Central access and proximity to healthcare

Temple

~9 min to Baylor Scott & White, the most central I-35 and airport access; not a daily-gate town.

The most house for your money plus strong schools

Harker Heights

The largest median home of the five (~2,150 sq ft) at ~\$145/sq ft, with the Killeen ISD draw, ~22 min from the gate.

The lake, newest builds, and a budget that allows it

Belton

Belton ISD, the newest inventory, and Belton Lake / Stillhouse Hollow access at the corridor's top median.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Get these numbers run for your budget

City-wide medians are a starting point, not your answer. Tell me your price band, your gate or hospital commute, and the schools that matter, and I'll pull the live MLS for exactly that and send back a short, honest fit list — no pressure, no spam.

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More guides & live listings: templetxhomes.net

Methodology & recency. Figures are from Bell County MLS pulls dated June 2026 (Copperas Cove from a June 23 corridor pull). Medians blend active and recently sold listings; price-per-square-foot is median price ÷ median home size — a proxy, not an appraisal. Drive times are off-peak Google Maps estimates from each city center; gate-rush adds time. School zoning and inventory change — confirm both by exact address before relying on this. Updated June 2026.

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